

¹⁴The Word became flesh and made His dwelling among us.^a We have seen His glory, the glory of the one and only Son^b from the Father, full of grace and truth.

¹⁵John testified concerning Him. He cried out, saying, “This is He of whom I said, ‘He who comes after me has surpassed me because He was before me.’”

¹⁶From His fullness we have all received grace upon grace. ¹⁷For the law was given through Moses; grace and truth came through Jesus Christ. ¹⁸No one has ever seen God, but the one and only Son, who is Himself God and^c is at the Father’s side,^d has made Him known.

The Mission of John the Baptist

Isaiah 40:1–5; Matthew 3:1–12; Mark 1:1–8; Luke 3:1–20

¹⁹And this was John’s testimony when the Jews of Jerusalem sent priests and Levites to ask him, “Who are you?” ²⁰He did not refuse to confess, but openly declared, “I am not the Christ.”

²¹“Then who are you?” they inquired. “Are you Elijah?”

He said, “I am not.”

“Are you the Prophet?”

He answered, “No.”

²²So they said to him, “Who are you? We need an answer for those who sent us. What do you say about yourself?”

²³John replied in the words of Isaiah the prophet:

“I am a voice of one calling in the wilderness,

‘Make straight the way for the Lord.’”^e

²⁴Then the Pharisees who had been sent ²⁵asked him, “Why then do you baptize, if you are not the Christ, nor Elijah, nor the Prophet?”

²⁶“I baptize with^f water,” John replied, “but among you stands One you do not know. ²⁷He is the One who comes after me, the straps of whose sandals I am not worthy to untie.”

²⁸All this happened at Bethany beyond the Jordan, where John was baptizing.

^aOr *and tabernacled among us*

^bOr *the Only Begotten or the Unique One*

^cOr *but the only begotten God, who; BYZ and TR but the only begotten Son, who*

^dGreek *in the Father’s bosom*

^eIsaiah 40:3 (see also LXX)

^fOr *in; also in verse 31 and twice in 33*

Jesus the Lamb of God

Matthew 3:13–17; Mark 1:9–11; Luke 3:21–22

²⁹The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and said, “Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world! ³⁰This is He of whom I said, ‘A man who comes after me has surpassed me because He was before me.’ ³¹I myself did not know Him, but the reason I came baptizing with water was that He might be revealed to Israel.”

³²Then John testified, “I saw the Spirit descending from heaven like a dove and resting on Him. ³³I myself did not know Him, but the One who sent me to baptize with water told me, ‘The man on whom you see the Spirit descend and rest is He who will baptize with the Holy Spirit.’ ³⁴I have seen and testified that this is the Son of God.”

The First Disciples

Matthew 4:18–22; Mark 1:16–20; Luke 5:1–11

³⁵The next day John was there again with two of his disciples. ³⁶When he saw Jesus walking by, he said, “Look, the Lamb of God!” ³⁷And when the two disciples heard him say this, they followed Jesus.

³⁸Jesus turned and saw them following. “**What do you want?**” He asked. They said to Him, “Rabbi” (which means Teacher), “where are You staying?”

³⁹“**Come and see,**” He replied. So they went and saw where He was staying, and spent that day with Him. It was about the tenth hour.^b

⁴⁰Andrew, Simon Peter’s brother, was one of the two who heard John’s testimony and followed Jesus. ⁴¹He first found his brother Simon and told him, “We have found the Messiah” (which is translated as Christ).

⁴²Andrew brought him to Jesus, who looked at him and said, “**You are Simon son of John. You will be called Cephas**” (which is translated as Peter).

Jesus Calls Philip and Nathanael

⁴³The next day Jesus decided to set out for Galilee. Finding Philip, He told him, “**Follow Me.**” ⁴⁴Now Philip was from Bethsaida, the same town as Andrew and Peter.

⁴⁵Philip found Nathanael and told him, “We have found the One Moses wrote about in the Law, the One the prophets foretold — Jesus of Nazareth, the son of Joseph.”

⁴⁶“Can anything good come from Nazareth?” Nathanael asked. “Come and see,” said Philip.

^aSBL *the Chosen One of God*

^bThat is, about four in the afternoon

⁴⁷When Jesus saw Nathanael approaching, He said of him, “**Here is a true Israelite, in whom there is no deceit.**”

⁴⁸“How do You know me?” Nathanael asked.

Jesus replied, “**Before Philip called you, I saw you under the fig tree.**”

⁴⁹“Rabbi,” Nathanael answered, “You are the Son of God! You are the King of Israel!”

⁵⁰Jesus said to him, “**Do you believe just because I told you I saw you under the fig tree? You will see greater things than these.**” ⁵¹Then He declared, “**Truly, truly, I tell you, you will all see heaven open and the angels of God ascending and descending on the Son of Man.**”^a

The Wedding at Cana



¹On the third day a wedding took place at Cana in Galilee. Jesus’ mother was there,

²and Jesus and His disciples had also been invited to the wedding. ³When the wine ran out, Jesus’ mother said to Him, “They have no more wine.”

⁴“**Woman, what is that to you and to Me?**” Jesus replied. “**My hour has not yet come.**”

⁵His mother said to the servants, “Do whatever He tells you.”

⁶Now six stone water jars had been set there for the Jewish rites of purification. Each could hold from twenty to thirty gallons.^b ⁷Jesus told the servants, “**Fill the jars with water.**”

So they filled them to the brim.

⁸“**Now draw some out,**” He said, “**and take it to the master of the banquet.**”

They did so, ⁹and the master of the banquet tasted the water that had been turned into wine. He did not know where it was from, but the servants who had drawn the water knew. Then he called the bridegroom aside ¹⁰and said, “Everyone serves the fine wine first, and then the cheap wine after the guests are drunk. But you have saved the fine wine until now!”

¹¹Jesus performed this, the first of His signs, at Cana in Galilee. He thus revealed His glory, and His disciples believed in Him.

Jesus Cleanses the Temple

Matthew 21:12–17; Mark 11:15–19; Luke 19:45–48

¹²After this, He went down to Capernaum with His mother and brothers and His disciples, and they stayed there a few days.

¹³When the Jewish Passover was near, Jesus went up to Jerusalem. ¹⁴In the temple courts^c He found men selling cattle, sheep, and doves, and

^aSee Genesis 28:12.

^bGreek two or three metretae; that is, approximately 20.8 to 31.2 gallons (78.8 to 118.1 liters)

money changers seated at their tables. ¹⁵So He made a whip out of cords and drove all from the temple courts, both sheep and cattle. He poured out the coins of the money changers and overturned their tables. ¹⁶To those selling doves He said, “**Get these out of here! How dare you turn My Father’s house into a marketplace!**”

¹⁷His disciples remembered that it is written: “Zeal for Your house will consume Me.”^a

¹⁸On account of this, the Jews demanded, “What sign can You show us to prove Your authority to do these things?”

¹⁹Jesus answered, “**Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up again.**”

²⁰“This temple took forty-six years to build,” the Jews replied, “and You are going to raise it up in three days?”

²¹But Jesus was speaking about the temple of His body. ²²After He was raised from the dead, His disciples remembered that He had said this. Then they believed the Scripture and the word that Jesus had spoken.

²³While He was in Jerusalem at the Passover Feast, many people saw the signs He was doing and believed in His name. ²⁴But Jesus did not entrust Himself to them, for He knew them all. ²⁵He did not need any testimony about man, for He knew what was in a man.

Jesus and Nicodemus

Genesis 22:1–10; Romans 5:6–11



¹Now there was a man of the Pharisees named Nicodemus, a leader of the Jews.

²He came to Jesus at night and said, “Rabbi, we know that You are a teacher who has come from God. For no one could perform the signs You are doing if God were not with him.”

³Jesus replied, “**Truly, truly, I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God unless he is born again.**”^b

⁴“How can a man be born when he is old?” Nicodemus asked. “Can he enter his mother’s womb a second time to be born?”

⁵Jesus answered, “**Truly, truly, I tell you, no one can enter the kingdom of God unless he is born of water and the Spirit. ⁶Flesh is born of flesh, but spirit is born of the Spirit. ⁷Do not be amazed that I said, ‘You^c must**

^cLiterally *the temple*; also in verse 15

^aPsalms 69:9

^bOr *born from above*; also in verse 7.

^cThe Greek word for *you* is plural; also in verse 12.

⁵³Then the father realized that this was the very hour in which Jesus had told him, “**Your son will live.**” And he and all his household believed.

⁵⁴This was now the second sign that Jesus performed after coming from Judea into Galilee.

The Pool of Bethesda

5

¹Some time later there was a feast of the Jews, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.

²Now there is in Jerusalem near the Sheep Gate a pool with five covered colonnades, which in Hebrew^a is called Bethesda.^b ³On these walkways^c lay a great number of the sick, the blind, the lame, and the paralyzed.^d

⁵One man there had been an invalid for thirty-eight years. ⁶When Jesus saw him lying there and realized that he had spent a long time in this condition, He asked him, “Do you want to get well?”

⁷“Sir,” the invalid replied, “I have no one to help me into the pool when the water is stirred. While I am on my way, someone else goes in before me.”

⁸Then Jesus told him, “Get up, pick up your mat, and walk.”

⁹Immediately the man was made well, and he picked up his mat and began to walk.

Now this happened on the Sabbath day, ¹⁰so the Jews said to the man who had been healed, “This is the Sabbath! It is unlawful for you to carry your mat.”

¹¹But he answered, “The man who made me well told me, ‘Pick up your mat and walk.’”

¹²“Who is this man who told you to pick it up and walk?” they asked.

¹³But the man who was healed did not know who it was, for Jesus had slipped away while the crowd was there.

¹⁴Afterward, Jesus found the man at the temple and said to him, “See, you have been made well. Stop sinning, or something worse may happen to you.”

¹⁵And the man went away and told the Jews that it was Jesus who had made him well.

^bThat is, one in the afternoon

^aOr in Aramaic

^bNA, NE, and WH Bethzatha

^cLiterally In these

^dNE, BYZ, and TR include *awaiting the moving of the waters*. ⁴For from time to time an angel descended into the pool and stirred the water. As soon as it was stirred, the first to enter the pool would be healed of his disease.

The Father and the Son

¹⁶Now because Jesus was doing these things on the Sabbath, the Jews began to persecute Him. ¹⁷But Jesus answered them, “To this very day My Father is at His work, and I too am working.”

¹⁸Because of this, the Jews tried all the harder to kill Him. Not only was He breaking the Sabbath, but He was even calling God His own Father, making Himself equal with God.

¹⁹So Jesus replied, “Truly, truly, I tell you, the Son can do nothing by Himself, unless He sees the Father doing it. For whatever the Father does, the Son also does. ²⁰The Father loves the Son and shows Him all He does. And to your amazement, He will show Him even greater works than these. ²¹For just as the Father raises the dead and gives them life, so also the Son gives life to whom He wishes.

²²Furthermore, the Father judges no one, but has assigned all judgment to the Son, ²³so that all may honor the Son just as they honor the Father. Whoever does not honor the Son does not honor the Father who sent Him.

²⁴Truly, truly, I tell you, whoever hears My word and believes Him who sent Me has eternal life and will not come under judgment. Indeed, he has crossed over from death to life.

²⁵Truly, truly, I tell you, the hour is coming and has now come when the dead will hear the voice of the Son of God, and those who hear will live. ²⁶For as the Father has life in Himself, so also He has granted the Son to have life in Himself. ²⁷And He has given Him authority to execute judgment, because He is the Son of Man.

²⁸Do not be amazed at this, for the hour is coming when all who are in their graves will hear His voice ²⁹and come out — those who have done good to the resurrection of life, and those who have done evil to the resurrection of judgment.^a

³⁰I can do nothing by Myself; I judge only as I hear. And My judgment is just, because I do not seek My own will, but the will of Him who sent Me.

Testimonies about Jesus

³¹If I testify about Myself, My testimony is not valid. ³²There is another who testifies about Me, and I know that His testimony about Me is valid.

³³You have sent to John, and he has testified to the truth. ³⁴Even though I do not accept human testimony, I say these things so that you may be saved.

³⁵John was a lamp that burned and gave light, and you were willing for a season to bask in his light. ³⁶But I have testimony more substantial than that of John. For the works that the Father has given Me to accomplish —

^aSee Daniel 12:2.